MIL-C-48254A (AR)
30 July 1984
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-48254
10 July 1975

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CHARGES, EXPELLING, FOR PROJECTILE, 155MM, ILLUMINATING, M485A2 LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

This specification is approved for use by the US Army Armament, Munitions and Chemical Command and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers two types of expelling charge assemblies for use in 155MM, Illuminating Projectile, M485A2.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the following specifications and standards of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-P-116	-	Preservation, Method of
MIL-P-223	-	Powder, Black
MIL-A-48078	-	Ammunition, Standard Quality Assurance Provisions, General Specification for

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage

FSC 1320

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Center, Attn. DRSMC-QA, Dover, New Jersey 07801 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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MIL-STD-1235 - Single and Multilevel Continuous Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

DRAWINGS (See 6.5)

US ARMY ARMAMENT RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CENTER (ARDC)

9213756 - Expelling Charge Assembly, Secondary
9370052 - Expelling Charge, Primary, Loading Assembly

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

TRANSPORTATION

49 CFR 100-199 - Interstate Commerce Commission Code of Federal Regulations for the Transportation of Explosives and Other Dangerous Articles

The Interstate Commerce Commission Regulations are now a part of the Code of Federal Regulations available from the Superintendent Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington D.C. 20402. Orders for the above publication should cite "49 CFR 100-199 (latest revision)".

INSPECTION

ANSI Y14.5-1975 - Dimensioning and Tolerancing

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Materials and parts shall be in accordance with applicable drawings and specifications.

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3.2 Expelling charge assemblies. The expelling charge assemblies shall comply with all requirements specified on drawing (dwg.) 9213756 and dwg. 9370052 as applicable, and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications.

3.3 Moisture content of black powder. The moisture content of the black powder at the time of loading expelling charge, primary, shall be 0.7 percent, maximum (max.) and for expelling charge, secondary, shall be 0.7 percent, (max.), when determined as specified in 4.4.3.1 and 4.5.1.

3.4 Leak test of expelling charge assembly, primary. Assemblies shall not exhibit any leakage when subjected to the leak test prescribed in 4.4.3.2 and 4.5.2.

3.5 Workmanship. The expelling charge assemblies shall be free from cracks, air bubbles, holes, blisters, dirt, grease and foreign material.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection and standard quality assurance provisions. Unless otherwise specified herein or in the contract, the provisions of MIL-A-48078 shall apply and are hereby made a part of this detail specification.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The following types of inspections shall be conducted on this item:

a. First Article Inspection.

b. Quality Conformance Inspection

4.3 First article inspection.

4.3.1 Submission. The contractor shall submit a first article sample as designated by the Contracting Officer for determination of conformance to 4.3.2. The first article sample shall consist of the following:

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PART DESCRIPTION	DRAWING	QUANTITY
Cup, Expelling Charge	9370053	15
Cover, Expelling Charge	9370054	15
Expelling Charge Primary Loading Assy (Prior to Sealing)	9370052	25
Expelling Charge Primary Loading Assy (Sealed)	9370052	25
Black Powder	9370052	15 ounces (oz)
Bag, Expelling Charge Secondary	9213757	15
Bag, Expelling Charge Secondary (Prior to closing)	9213756	15
Black Powder	9213756	3 ounces (oz)
Expelling Charge Secondary	9213756	20

4.3.2 Inspections to be performed. See MIL-A-48078 and Table I herein.

4.3.3 Rejection. See MIL-A-48078.

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TABLE I. First Article Inspection.

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-48254A (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE: Charges, Expelling for Projectile, 155MM, Illuminating, M485A2, LAP		SHEET 1 OF 2		DRAWING NUMBER: SEE BELOW NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	Cup, Expelling Charge (Dwg. 9370053)				
	Examination for defects	15		3.1	4.4.2.1
	Cover, Expelling Charge (Dwg. 9370054)				
	Examination for defects	15		3.1	4.4.2.2
	Expelling Charge Primary Loading Assy (Prior to sealing) (Dwg. 9370052)				
	Examination for defects	25		3.1	4.4.2.3
	Moisture content of black powder	15 oz		3.3	4.4.3.1/4.5.1
	Expelling Charge Primary Loading Assy (Sealed) (Dwg. 9370052)				
	Examination for defects	25		3.1	4.4.2.4
	Leak test	25		3.4	4.4.3.2/4.5.2
	Bag, Expelling Charge Secondary (Dwg. 9213757)				
	Examination for defects	15		3.4	4.4.2.5

NOTES:

DRSMC-OA (D) Form 160, 1 Aug 83 replaces edition of 1 Jul 77 which may be used until exhausted.

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TABLE I. First Article Inspection.

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS MIL-C-48254A (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 2 OF 2		DRAWING NUMBER
	Charges, Expelling for Projectile, 155MM, Illuminating, M485A2, LAP				SEE BELOW
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	Bag, Expelling Charge Secondary (Prior to closing bag) (Dwg. 9213756)				
	Examination for defects	15		3.1	4.4.2.6
	Moisture content of black powder	3 oz		3.3	4.4.3.1/4.5.1
	Expelling Charge Secondary (Dwg. 9213756)				
	Examination for defects	20		3.1	4.4.2.7

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4.4 Quality conformance inspection.

4.4.1 Inspection lot formation. Inspection lots shall comply with the lot formation provisions of MIL-A-48078. In addition, inspection lots of expelling charges (primary and secondary) shall contain:

a. Cups of one lot interfix from not more than one manufacturer.

b. Covers of one lot interfix from not more than one manufacturer.

c. Bags of one lot interfix from not more than one manufacturer.

d. Black powder from not more than one manufacturer.

4.4.2 Examination. See MIL-A-48078.

a. Sampling plans. Unless otherwise specified in the Classification of Defects and Test tables, sampling plans for major and minor defects shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1235 or MIL-STD-105 as applicable. Inspection Level shall be II.

b. Automatic gaging. Facilities equipped with Government furnished automatic gaging capable of performing 100% inspection of any characteristic shall utilize this capability in accordance with the contract.

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-48254A (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER 9370053
4.4.2.1	Cup, Expelling Charge				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY 9370052
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
CRITICAL:	None defined				
MAJOR:					
101	Length of protrusion at bottom of cup		0.40%	3.1	Gage
102	Outside diameter of lip		0.40%	3.1	Gage
103	Detail "C" (see dwg. 9370053)			3.1	
MINOR:					
201	Total length		0.65%	3.1	Gage
202	Inside diameter of closed end		0.65%	3.1	Gage
203	Inside diameter of open end		0.65%	3.1	Gage
204	Thickness of side wall of cup		0.65%	3.1	Gage
205	Width of protrusion at bottom of cup		0.65%	3.1	Gage
206	Recessed outside diameter at inside rear of cup		0.65%	3.1	Gage
207	Inside diameter at inside rear of cup		0.65%	3.1	Gage
208	Radii or angles missing or incorrect		0.65%	3.1	Visual
209	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.5	Visual

NOTES:

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER 9370054
4.4.2.2	Cover, Expelling Charge				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY 9370052
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
CRITICAL:	None defined				
MAJOR:					
101	Detail "A" (see dwg. 9370054)			3.1	
MINOR:					
201	Outside diameter		0.65%	3.1	Gage
202	Thickness		0.65%	3.1	Gage
203	Diameter of lip opening at centers		0.65%	3.1	Gage
204	Radii or chamfer missing or incorrect		0.65%	3.1	Visual
205	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.5	Visual

NOTES:

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-C-48254A (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER 9370052
4.4.2.3	Expelling Charge Primary Loading Assembly (Prior to sealing)				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY 9214150
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
CRITICAL:	None defined				
MAJOR:					
101	Expelling charge cup not volumetrically filled with black powder		0.40%	3.1	Visual
102	Moisture content of black powder	*		3.3	4.4.3.1/4.5.1
MINOR:					
201	Foreign matter in charge		0.65%	3.1	Visual
202	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.5	Visual

NOTES:

* Sample size as specified in applicable test method paragraph.

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER 9370052
4.4.2.4	Expelling Charge, Primary, Loading Assy (Sealed)				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY 9214150
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
CRITICAL:	None defined				
MAJOR:					
101	Charge missing or insufficient		100%	3.1	Visual
102	Evidence of black powder external to cup		100%	3.1	Visual
103	Assembly incompletely or improperly sealed (leak test)		100%	3.4	4.4.3.2/4.5.2
MINOR:					
201	Total length, max		0.65%	3.1	Gage
202	Diameter, max		0.65%	3.1	Gage
203	Marking missing, misleading or unidentifiable		0.65%	3.1	Visual
204	Evidence of poor workmanship		.65%	3.5	Visual

NOTES:

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.5	Bag, Expelling Charge, Secondary (before loading)	1 OF 1	9213757
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY 9213756

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
CRITICAL:	None defined				
MAJOR:	None defined				
MINOR:					
201	Length of bag		0.65%	3.1	Gage
202	Width of bag		0.65%	3.1	Gage
203	Distance between stitches		0.65%	3.1	Gage
204	Length and width of stitching		0.65%	3.1	Gage
205	Line of stitches (profile)		0.65%	3.1	Visual
206	Width of flap opening (2 places)		0.65%	3.1	Gage
207	Radii missing		0.65%	3.1	Visual
208	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.5	Visual

NOTES:

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.6	Bag, Expelling Charge, Secondary (Prior to closing bag)	1 OF 1	9213756
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY: 9213756

CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
CRITICAL:	None defined				
MAJOR:					
101	Weight of charge out of tolerance		0.40%	3.1	Gage
102	Charge missing		0.40%	3.2	Visual 4.4.3.1/4.5.1
103	Moisture content of black powder	*		3.3	
MINOR:					
201	Bag not inside out (optional)		0.65%	3.1	Visual
202	Foreign matter not in charge		0.65%	3.5	Visual
203	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.5	Visual

NOTES:

* Sample size as specified in applicable test method paragraph.

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER 9213756
4.4.2.7	Expelling Charge, Secondary				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY 9213758
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
CRITICAL:	None defined				
MAJOR:					
101	Charge missing		100%	3.1	Visual/Manual
102	Assembly damaged to extent charge can escape		0.40%	3.5	Visual
103	Evidence of black powder external to bag assembly		100%	3.1	Visual
MINOR:					
201	Any seam or opening incompletely stitched or damaged		0.65%	3.1	Visual
202	Thread(s) broken		0.65%	3.1	Visual
203	Marking missing, incorrect or unidentifiable		0.65%	3.1	Visual
204	Evidence of poor workmanship		0.65%	3.5	Visual

NOTES:

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4.4.3 Testing. Testing is described in the First Article and Quality Conformance Inspection Tables.

4.4.3.1 Moisture content of black powder. The moisture content of the black powder used in loading the expelling charge assemblies shall be determined at the time of loading. The contractor shall test at least one sample of black powder from each eight hours production, or portion thereof, of each expelling charge (primary and secondary). Any failure to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the production represented by the samples. If loading has begun, assemblies loaded with the non-conforming black powder shall be rejected. The test shall be as specified in paragraph 4.5.1.

4.4.3.2 Ultrasonic seal test of expelling charge assembly (primary). Each assembly shall be subjected to a leak test in accordance with 4.5.2. Any assembly exhibiting leakage shall be cause for rejection and eliminated from further production processing.

4.4.4 Inspection equipment. The inspection equipment requirement to perform the examinations and tests prescribed herein is described in the Paragraph Reference/Inspection Method column in the tables starting with Paragraph 4.4.2.1. The contractor shall submit for approval inspection equipment designs in accordance with the terms of the contract. See Section 6 of MIL-A-48078 and 6.3 herein.

4.4.4.1 Automatic inspection equipment. All automatic test and inspection equipment when utilized by the contractor shall be subjected to periodic verification and/or calibration check during production. The procedures shall include as a minimum: Frequency, method of verification, and the method of retrieval of item produced between verification/calibration. These procedures shall be included in the operation/calibration procedures as required by the above paragraph.

4.5 Test methods and procedures.

4.5.1 Moisture content of black powder. The moisture content of black powder shall be determined in accordance with specification MIL-P-223.

4.5.2 Ultrasonic seal test of expelling charge assembly (primary). Each assembly subjected to this test shall be placed in a transparent pressure vessel which contains sufficient water (H_2^0) so that the assembly is completely immersed to a minimum depth of one inch. The vessel shall then be sealed and the pressure shall be reduced from 760 mm Hg (atmospheric) to 700 mm Hg. The vacuum shall

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be maintained for a minimum of twenty seconds. Any indication of air bubbles emitting from the expelling charge assembly, particular in the area of the ultrasonic seal shall be cause for rejection, the unit classified as defective and removed from the lot.

4.5.3 Dimensional control of molded or plastic parts. In place of the normal sampling and inspections associated with the Classification of Defects, and after a curing time for the parts has been approved (see Note 1) a sample of four (4) parts (as molded) from each cavity shall be fully inspected dimensionally to qualify a new or reworked cavity for use in production. The molded parts shall carry the individual cavity identification. As a control of each cavity during production, the above quantity of parts from each cavity shall be inspected for at least the defects listed in paragraphs 4.4.2.1 through 4.4.2.2 after continuous production of each 5,000 parts or at the end of each week, whichever occurs first. Of the four (4) samples, one (1) sample shall be the last part produced. If any defective parts are found during qualification of the cavity, the cavity producing the defective part will not be used in production. If any defective parts are found when inspection is performed for the control of the cavity, the cavity producing the defective part shall be removed from production. Further, that portion of production since the last control check shall be returned to the contractor for inspection for each separate type of defect according to MIL-STD-105, using an AQL of 0.40 percent for each major defect and an AQL of 0.65 percent for each minor defect. All cavities removed from production because of some fault, may, after reworking, be returned to production providing they pass the qualification test above. The contractor may request a change of inspection frequency providing he presents objective evidence to the Contracting Officer to substantiate the request. Contractor designs of gages and test equipment required to perform the inspections listed herein shall be forwarded to Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Center, ATTN: DRSMC-QAR-Q(D) Dover, New Jersey 07801, for approval prior to manufacturer of equipment. The noted sub-paragraphs identify those items and minimum inspections subjected to the requirements of this paragraph.

NOTE 1: In establishing a curing time, dimensionally check ten (10) parts from each cavity at periodic intervals (e.g., every 30, 60, etc mins) until dimensional stability is attained. The curing time will be from the time the part comes out of the mold until dimensional stability is attained. The inspection data used in determining the curing time shall be sent to Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Center, ATTN: DRSMC-QAR-Q(D), Dover, New Jersey 07801. If there is a change in material, or in the cycle time, or if a cavity is reworked, or a new cavity is used, a new curing time shall be established and approved.

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5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packing.

5.1.1 Level C. The expelling charge assemblies shall be packed in accordance with the Code of Federal Regulations "49 CFR 100-199" and to afford protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use.

5.2 Marking. In addition to any marking required by the contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-129 and Code of Federal Regulations "49 CFR 100-199". The DOT marking shall be "BLACK POWDER".

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The components covered by this specification are intended for use on the Projectile, 155MM, Illuminating, M485A2.

6.2 Ordering data. See MIL-A-48078.

6.3 Submission of inspection procedures and equipment desgns for approval. See MIL-A-48078. Submit equipment designs as required to: Commander USARDC, ATTN: DRSMC-QAR-I (D), Dover, NJ 07801.

6.4 Visual examination qualification. When compliance with the applicable requirement is in doubt as result of visual examination, the characteristics may be measured or gaged to determine acceptability.

6.5 Drawings. Drawings listed in Section 2 of this specification under the heading US Army Armament, Munitions and Chemical Command (AMCCOM) may also include drawings prepared by Rock Island Arsenal, Edgewood Arsenal, Frankford Arsenal, Picatinny Arsenal or ARRADCOM. Technical data originally prepared by these activities is now under the cognizance of AMCCOM.

6.6 Statements of findings shall show the specific analytical results of each test or inspection performed as required by the applicable drawing or specification together with the specified acceptable limits.

6.7 Submission of first article samples. Instructions as to the location for the evaluation of initial production shall be obtained from the contracting officer. Upon receipt of such request, the contracting officer shall advice the US Army Armament Research and Development Center, ATTN: DRSMC-QAR-Q(D), and instructions will be issued accordingly.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-48254A	PROJECTILE, EXPELLING, FOR PROJECTILE, 155MM, ILLUM M485A1

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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